



Benito Mussolini mingles with his Fascist Blackshirt paramilitaries in Rome after being appointed prime minister by the Italian king in October.

forces and devastated by fire. Britain contemplated intervening against the Turks, but in an **armistice** agreed to at **Mudanya** in October both the European powers and Greece accepted the Turkish military victory. Under the agreed to peace terms there was a large-scale exchange of people, with over a million Greeks expelled from Turkey and half a million Turks forced to leave Greece. Abandoned Greek villages in western Turkey still bear witness to this human tragedy. **The Republic of Turkey was founded** the following year, with Mustafa Kemal as its first president.

1922 was the year when **Benito Mussolini** (1883–1945) achieved

power in Italy. Since the end of World War I, Italy's ruling class had been intimidated by waves of militant action, with socialist workers occupying factories and peasants taking over large estates. In this troubled situation, Mussolini founded the *fasci di combattimento*, a **nationalist militia** that attacked socialists and seized power by force in some Italian towns. In October, Mussolini threatened to lead his **Fascist** followers in a "March on Rome" unless he was made head of government. Italy's king, Victor Emmanuel III (1869–1947), eventually gave in and Mussolini assumed office as prime minister. Once in control, Mussolini began

dismantling Italy's system of parliamentary democracy.

As Mussolini was muscling his way to power, the **first national radio broadcasting company** was being established in Britain. Like the early radio stations that were starting up in the US, the British Broadcasting Company (later Corporation) was financed by manufacturers of radio sets, eager to create a market for their products. And it worked; by March 1923, daily broadcasts of concerts, news, and talks had attracted 125,000 people to buy licenses from the Post Office for their "wirelesses." The US would not have a major broadcasting network until the formation of

“EITHER THE GOVERNMENT WILL BE GIVEN TO US OR WE SHALL SEIZE IT BY MARCHING ON ROME.”

Benito Mussolini, October 24, 1922

the National Broadcasting Company (NBC) in 1926.

New **modernist trends in literature** were prominent in 1922. Irish writer James Joyce's novel *Ulysses*, published in Paris in February, broke all literary conventions, but its language and subject matter ensured that it was banned as obscene in countries with tighter censorship rules than France. The more decorous American expatriate poet T. S. Eliot caused a sensation with his long and obscure poem

The Waste Land, which came with notes to help the reader follow its numerous literary allusions. Experimentation was also rife in **the movies**, from German director F. W. Murnau's expressionist horror movie *Nosferatu* to American filmmaker Robert Flaherty's groundbreaking documentary *Nanook of the North*.

Russia was entering a period of relative tranquillity, after the upheavals of revolution and civil war. At the year's end the former Russian Empire was reconstituted as the **Union of Soviet Socialist Republics**

"Father of the Turks"

Mustafa Kemal, the founder of the Turkish Republic, talks with camel drivers during the Turko-Greek War. He later took the name Atatürk.



Early airwaves

Early radio sets were often impressive-looking pieces of equipment. This one, from 1925, has an unusual, star-shaped antenna.

(USSR), but by then the founder of the world's first communist state, **Vladimir Lenin** (see 1917) had been disabled by a stroke. Despite this, he dictated a document, later known as "**Lenin's Testament**," that was critical of several of his colleagues. In particular, it warned against the rudeness and intolerance of **Joseph Stalin** (1978–1953), newly installed as the Soviet Communist Party's General Secretary, and proposed that he be removed from his post. After Lenin's death, knowledge of the document was restricted to a communist inner circle, and action against Stalin was never taken.



- August 9** Chinese nationalist leader **Sun Yat-sen** flees southern China for Hong Kong after defeat by warlord Chen Jiongming
- July 31** General strike in Italy crushed by Mussolini's Fascists
- August 22** Michael Collins, head of Irish Free State, army, and government, is killed in an ambush
- August 26–30** Battle of Dumlupinar gives Turkey victory in Greco-Turkish War
- September 11** British Mandate proclaimed in Palestine
- September 13–17** City of Smyrna (Izmir) destroyed by fire
- September 27** King Constantine of Greece abdicates as result of defeat by Turkey
- October 23** Left-wing uprising suppressed in Saxony, Germany
- October 28** Japanese troops withdraw from Vladivostok, ending foreign military intervention in Russia
- October 11** Mudania Convention averts war between British troops and Turkish nationalists at Chanak
- October 30** Mussolini comes to power in Italy
- November 1** End of Ottoman Empire as Sultan Mehmed IV abdicates, Turkey becomes republic
- November 14** British Broadcasting Company (BBC) makes its first radio broadcast
- November 15** Labour Party becomes main opposition to Conservatives in British election
- November 26** British archaeologists enter tomb of Tutankhamun in Egypt
- December 6** Irish Free state officially founded
- December 16** First president of Polish Republic, **Gabriel Narutowicz**, assassinated after five days in office
- December 30** Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (USSR) is founded